

Monica Cholico

Creative Developer & Visual Storyteller

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August 21, 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm a web engineer on the TBrand Creative Tech team, and I'm writing to express my interest in the Associate Newsroom Software Engineer position on the Interactive News Technology team. My daily stack — JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Svelte, and AI-assisted development with Cursor — maps directly to the tools your team uses, and the mission of building technology that empowers journalists and serves readers is exactly the direction I want to grow in.

For the past five years at the Times, I've built templates and bespoke interactive experiences for our advertisers, working closely with designers, producers, and cross-functional partners across Ad Mission. I've taken projects from concept through technical design to production, including building reusable template systems that other teams depend on. While this work has been on the business side, it's given me a strong foundation in building reliable, scalable web applications within the standards and pace of this organization.

What draws me to Interactive News is the chance to apply those engineering skills to journalism. Outside of my current role, I've been building toward this on my own time. Planeta Mujer (planeta-mujer.org) is an interactive platform I designed and coded from scratch — using D3.js, Canvas API, and scroll-driven navigation — to explore gender equality data and make complex issues accessible through visualization and storytelling. I also write bilingual explanatory articles for a publication I've run since 2014. I have a master's in gender and social policy, completed NYU's Modern Journalism certificate, and recently finished a diplomado in digital experiences, marketing, and ecosystems. I'm not a journalist yet, but I'm someone who thinks editorially, questions constantly, and has ideas for how technology can help people understand the world.

I'm also genuinely excited about the AI dimension of this role. I use Cursor and Claude daily — not just for code generation but for architectural thinking, iteration, and review. I built a workflow automation prototype using Anthropic's API to parse Slack messages into structured Jira tickets through a multi-step AI pipeline. I'm eager to bring that hands-on experience with AI tools to newsroom product development.

I know I'd be transitioning from the business side into the newsroom, and I'm honest about that gap. But I believe my technical skills, my editorial curiosity, and my drive to build things that help people understand complex issues make me a strong fit for this team. I'd welcome the opportunity to contribute.

Sincerely,

Monica Cholico